



fifth-place finish for another season.

Kick Sauber, the slowest team last time around, may be stuck behind the entire field again. The slow lap time and long-run pace indicate an uphill task right from the get-go.

With veteran Nico Hulkenberg and F2 champion Gabriel Bortoleto at the helm, they will hope to make gains before it's too late.

Rookie show

Several rookies stepping into

full-time F1 roles made headway during testing. Racing Bulls' Isack Hadjar logged the most mileage, covering a distance equivalent to four Bahrain Grands Prix. Jack Doohan and Bortoleto gained valuable track time, while Haas' Oliver Bearman made the most of a fresh start.

Looking forward

A two-week gap between pre-season testing and the season-opening Melbourne race

Back on the track: Max Verstappen (left) and Lewis Hamilton (above) during the pre-season testing at Bahrain. GETTYIMAGES

suggests that the teams will be in a race against time to get their challengers up and running. But what is certain is that 2025 will be a highly competitive year, with closer-than-ever track battles and 24 thrilling races.

Marquez brothers conquer MotoGP opener in Buriram

Marc Marquez delivered a stunning debut for the factory Ducati MotoGP team, completing a perfect treble at the 2025 opener Thailand Grand



Prix — winning the sprint, securing pole, and dominating the main race with a strategic masterclass.

Marc sat behind his brother, Gresini's Alex Marquez, for much of the race after losing the lead early to what seemed like a mechanical issue. The six-time champion regained his pace and managed tyre pressures before making his decisive move with four laps to go.

Alex slotted in behind to ensure a 1-2 finish for the Spanish brothers, while Ducati's Francesco Bagnaia, 2024 runner-up, had to settle for third despite closing in late.

Defending champion Jorge Martin was and will be out of action for the first few races after suffering a string of crashes ahead of the season. With two surgeries and a couple of fractures to heal from, the Spaniard will hope to get back on track soon to protect his crown.